

Social and Therapeutic Horticulture

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Social and Therapeutic Horticulture (A09746)

Short Title: Social and Therapeutic Hort
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Horticulture
Author LCASSIN
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module will provide students with an opportunity to review current practices in horticultural therapy and to gain an understanding of the benefits and uses of horticulture for the needs of different groups.

Programmes

HORT-0049	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	3 / 6 / E
HORT-0049	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	3 / 6 / E

Indicative Content

- Origins of horticultural therapy, history of use
- Examine range of applications, needs of different groups, prison gardens, care farms, visually impaired, learning difficulties, physical disabilities, and school gardens
- Examine the range of adaptive equipment available for different needs, therapeutic qualities of plants, plant selection for different needs, and design considerations
- Methods used in assessment to modify horticultural activities and assess abilities at horticultural tasks, resources available, and case studies

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Explore the origins of horticulture therapy.
2. Analyse the impact of horticultural therapy on a range of different user groups.
3. Recommend a range of tools and suitable plants for a variety of therapeutic situations.
4. Develop appropriate session plans for a group in a horticulture setting.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Using live plant materials for specialist purposes.
- Lectures
- Practical demonstrations
- Guest speaker/Site visit

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	70%	1,2,3
Continuous Assessment	30%	
<i>Project</i>	30%	4

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to carry out critical thinking or practical skills.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrates a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem solving. Adequate practical skills.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrates satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrates skilled and sound knowledge of the subject matter. Shows ability to analyse and logically discuss in an effective way. Good critical thinking and a high level of competence and efficiency in theoretical and practical areas of this subject.
- 70%-100%:** All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrates authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Practical	12	
Field Trips	12	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Adil, J.R. _Accessible gardening: A guide for people with disabilities_. U.S: Woodbine, 1994.
- Simson, S.P. and M.C. Straus. _Horticulture as therapy: Principles and Practices_. NY: Haworth Press, 1998.

Supplementary Material

- Hewson, M.L. _Horticulture as therapy: A practical guide to using horticulture as a therapeutic tool_. Canada: Hewson, 1994.

Requested Resources

- Lecture Room: Loose Seated